Zionism is still widely demonized as a form of oppression, expansion and illegitimacy.[7] This is so much the case that even those fully accepting of the Jewish State use the term "Zionism" in a way unrecognisable to most Jews. Why has this hostility gained such traction in the "new South Africa" among politicians, intellectuals, and the media?

One important factor has been the radicalization of a new Muslim generation, more educated than their forebears. They are now an influential and important component of South African society, despite comprising less than two percent of the total population. Moreover, Muslims in South Africa have long been hostile to the Zionist enterprise. As early as 1925, a local newspaper, *Muslim Outlook*, criticised "Jewish capitalists" in Palestine for allegedly forcing Arab peasants off the land.[8] The Israeli War of Independence (1947–48) was described at the time in the Muslim press as a catastrophe (*Nakba*).[9] Further Israeli victories against Arab forces, culminating in the Six-Day War (1967), exacerbated anger as South African Muslims shared in the humiliation of their Muslim "brothers and sisters."[10]

Yet throughout the apartheid period (1948–1994), white South Africans experienced a sense of quiescence on the part of their Muslim compatriots. In part this was because of the nature of apartheid separation and in part because of a general conservatism among Muslim leaders. But there were signs of change when in 1961 an influential pamphlet, *Call of Islam*, denounced apartheid.[11] By the time Israeli forces occupied southern Lebanon in 1982, radicalization was well underway: a new generation of Muslims had begun to challenge its more conservative elders. Inspired by radical teachings and by the African student uprising in Soweto in 1976, and buttressed by Khomeinism and the international Muslim struggle against imperialism, younger Muslims rejected the more accommodating behaviour of the Muslim establishment. Increasingly, as Muslims became acquainted with the anti-state writings of Abdul A'la Mawdudi (1903–1979) and Sayyid Qutb (1906–1966), they began to focus on the Zionist intrusion into Palestine, while readers of *Muslim News* were warned about "Zionist designs." It was even suggested that they read the *Protocols of the Elders of Zion* and familiarize themselves with the enemy.[12]

In the 1970s a search began among younger Muslims for a "socially relevant Islam," as epitomised in the formation of the Muslim Youth Movement in 1970 and the Muslim Students Association in 1974.[13] A range of Islamic activities was increasingly coordinated and guided by what was understood to be an authentic modern Islamic paradigm that, while not focusing on apartheid, did not entirely ignore it.[14] In calling for an "Islamic way of life," groups such as the Muslim Youth Movement "reflected the black

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